

Zachary Butler

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To the hiring manager:

I started my career as a classroom teacher — college composition at Montevallo, GRE and LSAT test prep for Kaplan — before transitioning into video production and working in Los Angeles as a documentary filmmaker and editor. At Cornell's Center for Teaching Innovation, those two paths converged: I was hired as a Video Producer, but my title was changed to Instructional Media Producer as my work grew to include working directly with faculty to build the instructional infrastructure that content lives in. I'm excited to see that the Program Facilitator role at the Argus Institute offers an opportunity to genuinely call on both sides of that background.

I've built and delivered online learning experiences working directly alongside faculty and instructional designers. At Cornell's Center for Teaching Innovation, I co-taught an 8-week faculty development workshop on video-based assignments delivered through Canvas with Panopto-hosted content — developing curriculum, facilitating sessions, and troubleshooting platform access for participants. I also produced two substantial faculty-collaboration projects: a branching-narrative interactive video for a data science ethics course (*Nobody's Fault*), and a full update of an edX MOOC on smartphone engineering with a Cornell computer architecture faculty member.

I translate complex academic work for general audiences — and I've done it at scale. Over four years at Cornell, I produced 3–5 short documentary films per year profiling innovative teaching practice across the university: following Doug McKee's work in Economics, Natasha Holmes's physics education research, Gen Meredeth's design of Cornell's Master of Public Health curriculum, and others. Each project required getting deep enough into the academic content to make the work legible to an audience without a disciplinary background.

I'm comfortable building and maintaining digital infrastructure that others depend on. At Lesson Zero Studio, I built the studio's operations from scratch — how projects came in, how files were organized, how finished work got to clients. At Cornell, I managed CTI's production media server and ingested final assets into the university's Widen DAM, tagging them to Cornell's metadata standards so they'd be findable across the institution. The Program Facilitator role adds registration and revenue collection at a scale I haven't managed before, but I've worked with tools in that space (Eventbrite, Square, Wave for invoicing), and those are gaps I can close quickly compared to the instructional coordination and platform management this role centers on.

I'm currently based in Laramie, Wyoming — 75 minutes from Fort Collins — and actively weighing relocation; the chance to work at the Argus Institute would make that an easy decision. I'd welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background fits what you're building.

Selected work samples:

- *Nobody's Fault* (Cornell Chronicle):
news.cornell.edu/stories/2023/06/teaching-ethics-data-science-through-immersive-video
- blogs.cornell.edu/nobodysfault/
- Transformative Teaching at Cornell: youtu.be/cNwFOf1NG8o
- Lesson Zero Studio: lessonzero.studio/work

Sincerely,

Zach Butler